ETCSL 5.3.2 — The debate between Grain and Sheep (Ezinu and Lahar / Ašnan and Lahar)

▼ Contents

Content 1
Files 1
Manuscripts 2
Line numbering 2
ETCSL bibliography (from the XML header) 2
Usefulness 2

- **Editors:** ETCSL project (J. Black, G. Cunningham, E. Robson, G. Zólyomi et al.), Oxford 1998–2006.
- **URLs:** transliteration https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=c.5.3.2&display=Crit&charenc=gcirc ; translation https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=t.5.3.2 ; ORACC: catalogue Q000761 only (no text in the 2022 JSON export)
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-16. The XML was copied from the local OTA 2518 bulk corpus (`../_bulk/etcsl-unzipped/etcsl/`); the live site and the Wayback HTML displays were not fetched this time (the XML is authoritative).
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Content

The cosmogonic prologue (1–36): when An begot the Anuna on the hill of heaven and earth, there was no grain, no sheep, no weaving, no clothing; mankind "did not know bread … like sheep they ate grass with their mouths"; the gods create Sheep and Grain on the Holy Mound, are not sated, and give them to mankind (26–36); Enki and Enlil send them down to the land (37–42); the two prosper (43–64), drink and quarrel (65–70); the debate (71–181); Enki's and Enlil's verdict for Grain (182–193).

Files

- `c.5.3.2.xml`, `t.5.3.2.xml` — ETCSL TEI source (2006 revised edition; lemmatised `<w form lemma pos label>`).

- `transliteration.md` (193 composite lines), `translation.md` — clean UTF-8 conversions by `../../../tools/etcsl2md.py`.

Manuscripts

Composite from many OB manuscripts (Nippur, Ur, unprovenanced; list in the XML header). ePSD2/literary has the composite as Q000761 in its catalogue but **no corpusjson** in the 2022 zip, so ETCSL's own lemmatisation (TEI `<w lemma>`) is the morphological aid.

Line numbering

ETCSL composite line numbers (193 lines). Translation paragraphs carry the line range they cover. Lines that only some manuscripts have are numbered with letters (e.g. `9A`) or given as variants in parentheses.

ETCSL bibliography (from the XML header)

- Alster and Vanstiphout 1987 (ASJ 9, edition); Vanstiphout 1997 (COS 1.180); Vanstiphout 1990, 1992; Bottéro 1991; Gragg 1973a.

Usefulness

Base text (rank 1) for the project `סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/2-טקסטי-בריאה-ועדן/`. ETCSL's prose translation is rank 3 (check only, after drafting).